

TITLE

A musical

By Your Name here

Contact:
Your Name
Address
Phone
Email

<< OR >>

Represented by:

CAST OF CHARACTERS

BOB, an elderly doctor

SUE, a young professor

JOHN, a brilliant student

MARY, a successful attorney

SETTINGS

Bob's office

Sue's classroom

John's kitchen

Mary's back yard

PRODUCTION NOTES

Time and place information goes here, along with anything else that will help the reader understand the script.

Production notes go here.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

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ACT I

SCENE 1

BANGOR INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT

It is a bright chaotic August day.

16-year-old CÁT LÝ, enters wearing a horse t-shirt, a backpack, and a 2018 exchange program lanyard. She holds a sign that reads "Nyberg."

SYBIL MA and her husband ERIC TRAN enter, searching anxiously. Eric holds a sign that reads "Cát Lý."

SYBIL

Horse shirt... Horse shirt... Horse...

ERIC

We've past a dozen horse girls.

SYBIL

Search an image of her.

ERIC

You know every Vietnamese person has a thousand others with the same name.

SYBIL

That's a one-syllable language problem.

Cát puzzledly spots Eric's sign.

CÁT

(Soliloquizing)

Troi đất oi. You got to be joking me. They promised me an authentic American experience. Those who'll nickname me Cathy cause they can't say Cát Lý. Out of all the families, I get...

(Back to reality)

Nybergs? Question mark?

SYBIL

Hon. Let's not start off correcting names.

ERIC

Xin chào. I'm Eric "Nyberg." It's my adoptive family's legal name. But I've taken back Tran.

The couple walks Cát to the car.

SYBIL

I've kept Ma. I'm Sybil Ma. Welcome to Maine.

CÁT

Good day, Mr. Tran and Mrs... Ma. It is an honor to make your acquaintance. I am Cathy.

They drive. Cát sits in the back, looking out at pines and granite.

ERIC

Nhìn gì?

CÁT

Nothing. I much prefer you speak English.

Cát takes out her phone and texts.

CÁT (CONT'D)

(to herself)

Dear Exchange Program Coordinator. I wish to report an error. My host family is Asi-

ERIC

By the way, our son is excited to meet you. He's a bit of a hermit.

SYBIL

The word is *introvert*.

Cát sighs and puts away the phone.

CÁT

This family needs friends.

Fade to black.

SCENE 2

THE TRAN HOUSE

The house is cozy as can be with a living room and bedrooms.

Cát and the Trans enter.

SYBIL

That will be your room.

ERIC

Bathroom's there with fresh towels.

CÁT

Water here might be amazing. Thank you lots, Eric and Mrs. Ma.

SYBIL

Right.

ERIC
Your new classmate's here!

MORGAN TRAN steps out, headphones
on his head and a Nautilus shell
necklace around his neck.

A beat as the teens lock eyes.

CÁT
A pleasure to meet you, Morgan. I've got
Indonesian / klepon for you

MORGAN
/ No need. Mom - dad's making salmon tonight.

Morgan hides away in his room.

SYBIL
Morgan. / Ăn đòn không, muốn ăn đòn không?!

CÁT
/ You said he's adopted from Indonesia, right?
/ Tiếng Việt của bạn hay quá, Mrs. Ma.

ERIC
Sorry, Cát. / He's a hermit.

SYBIL
Cam on, Cathy. / Introvert.

ERIC
It'll take time for him to warm up to you.

CÁT
(Soliloquizing)
It'll take forever to warm up an *absolute zero*.

Cát unpacks her clothes, many
deliberately plain shirts and
jeans in hopes of blending in. She
finds that her parents has packed
her horseshoe crab shirt as well.

CÁT (CONT'D)
The pot calling the kettle black. My parents
hid this in my luggage... I'll keep it 100.
This semester would go bad for horseshoe girl
Cát Lý. But not horse girl Cathy.

Cát throws the horseshoe crab
shirt in the trash. She puts on a
horse hoodie and stiff jeans. She
saddles up.

Fade to black.

SCENE 3

HORSE RANCH

By the stable yard fence, Cát stands nervously with the previous clothes, an attempt to seem cool.

HORSE GIRL enters, looking fabulous in their boots.

CÁT

I am a horse girl. Not a horseshoe girl...

HORSE GIRL

Did you adjust the saddle fit on Curless? The bridging be off yesterday.

CÁT

Bridging? Saddle fit? Half-pad? *Equus ferus caballus*... This is harder than Latin.

TRAINER (OFFSTAGE)

Cát... Um lie? Lee?

CÁT

Call me Cathy!

Cát walks off.

Morgan walks past the stables with a sketchbook in hand. He draws.

MORGAN

Cát's trying to be a cowgirl... Haha, so sad.

TRAINER (OFFSTAGE)

Fix your posture! Heels down! Relax them hips!

CÁT (OFFSTAGE)

Relaxing hard! Relax ah! Troi đất oi!

We hear Cát fall off the horse.

Horse Girl runs off. Morgan seems embarrassed. He goes to his car.

HORSE GIRL (OFFSTAGE)

How are you making out?

CÁT (OFFSTAGE)

What...?

HORSE GIRL (OFFSTAGE) (CONT'D)

You okay?

Horseshoe Girl helps Cát walk in and reach Morgan.

CÁT (CONT'D)

I don't belong on this soil...

HORSE GIRL

Neither do me nor my buddy. We've got quirks.
You just gotta find where you fitting. Morgan,
you're actually getting outta the house.

MORGAN

She's my host sister and I have to babysit her.

Horse Girl helps Cát get into
Morgan's car. They drive off.

MORGAN (CONT'D)

Still trying to be a cowgirl?

CÁT

Horse girl. They're a specific subspecies. Hard
to communicate.

MORGAN

Subspecies- I've not heard you talk that way.

CÁT

I fell on my head real hard. / *Ham chôi thì vua
vua thối chu...*

MORGAN

/ Let's head home and get that checked out.

Cát sees the sketchbook. It is an
abstract pattern drawing that
embodies Cát and the horse.

CÁT

I need to change...

MORGAN

You don't need to change. Your headspace just
needs the right environment.

Fade to black.

SCENE 4

BAGADUCE RIVER

It is a cloudy September day.

By the rocky algae-covered banks,
Cát and Morgan walk along it.

CÁT

The tidal range is amazing. Two meters. In
Haiphong, we get half that. I wonder why.

MORGAN

Ma can explain this when she gets off her call.

CÁT

Life as a marine engineer must be fun.

MORGAN

Today's actually a fun day for her. A phone call instead of driving two hours to Bath Iron.

CÁT

Maine has the weirdest names. *Bath Iron. Lubec.* Towns named Sweden, Mexico. *Damariscotta.*

He stops and picks up something.

MORGAN

You're weird.

CÁT

Says the hermit.

MORGAN

It's no hermit. *It's your thing.*

He shows a horseshoe crab shell.

CÁT

EEEEEEK! A LIMULUS POLYPHEMUS!
(Recomposing herself)
That's not my thing.

MORGAN

No one in the house wears animal shirts.

CÁT

You dug through trash? *Question mark?*

MORGAN

Your horseshoe crab shirt stuck out, okay. It's your thing.

He hands her the shell. The first time they've genuinely connected.

CÁT

It's... beautiful. The size. The condition. I'm surprised as they haven't spawned for months.

MORGAN

I can find shells any time. I'm okay at that.

CÁT

Where did you find Nautilus? Those are rare.

MORGAN

I got it when I was little...

CÁT

The tsunami. I'm sorry.

MORGAN

I don't remember- I just remember this shell.
Rescuers found me washed up with it. It's my
good-luck shell. The one memory of my family.

Sybil enters, done with a call.

SYBIL

Another find? Alright. The weather looks like
it's going to get out of hand. Let's head home.

They head into their car.

MORGAN

Can you explain how these tides are tides?

SYBIL

That's the first.

MORGAN

It's for Cát.

SYBIL

Makes sense.

Time passes. It is now raining.
Cát and Morgan sit in the back as
Sybil drives. They're nearly home.

RADIO (V.O.)

A powerful earthquake rocked the island of
Sulawesi today, triggering a 10-foot-tall
tsunami that swept away houses-

Sybil parks the car and switches
the key off.

SYBIL

Salmon is spawning and warm inside.

Sybil gets out of the car.

The breaking news breaks their
connection. Too much for Morgan.

CÁT

Morgan? *Question mark?*

He puts on his headphones and
turns up his music.

He quickly exits the car and heads to the house, sealing himself off.

Cát looks at the horseshoe shell then her exchange program lanyard.

CÁT (CONT'D)

Head home to your shell. He's a hermit with nowhere to go. I have nowhere to go. Maybe, we both are lost here. *Period.*

Fade to black.

SCENE 5

THE TRAN HOUSE

It is past bedtime. Lights up on the doorway to Morgan's bedroom. Eric goes to it.

ERIC

I don't think it's a good idea to eat salmon, especially around a bed.

Cát enters brushing her teeth.

ERIC (CONT'D)

Where does a hermit go when they got no shell?

CÁT

(Mouth full)

They die?

ERIC

No, they find a bigger shell. Whatever he's going through, he's a bigger man in the end.

Eric goes off to bed.

Cát gets the horseshoe shell.

CÁT

We're both orphaned in this country. I am by choice, briefly abandoning my home. He is by tragedy, searching for... home?

Cát holds the horseshoe shell up.

CÁT (CONT'D)

I wish we could both feel at home. I wish for Morgan to be a bigger man in the end.

Cát turns off the light and rests.

Black out.

ACT II

SCENE 1

THE TRAN HOUSE

It is the morning of October 23.

A sudden snowstorm rages outside.

The landline phone rings. Cát wakes up and picks it up.

CÁT

Whattttttt's upppppp? Questioonnnn marrkkkk-

SYBIL (V.O.)

The snow! Roads are awful. Snow in October?!

Cát stares out the window. This is her first time seeing snow.

ERIC (V.O.)

Typical Maine.

CÁT

How is the ship... um?

SYBIL (V.O.)

The ship christening was fantastic.

ERIC (V.O.)

The Nyberg legacy holds strong.

CÁT

Aren't you driving your parents today?

ERIC (V.O.)

That's tomorrow's problem.

SYBIL (V.O.)

Go experience your first snow day without us.

CÁT (V.O.)

It's okay. I can wait til tomorrow.

SYBIL (V.O.)

No no. A school snow day.

ERIC (V.O.)

Check the school app, girrrl.

Cát reads her phone.

CÁT

School's canceled? Where will I go?

SYBIL (V.O.)
Back to bed, dear.

ERIC (V.O.)
We'll see you tomorrow, kiddo.

SYBIL (V.O.)
Wake up Morgan so you can drink your first hot
coco too.

ERIC (V.O.)
A hermit's favorite drink I always say.

The landline phone hangs up.

CÁT
How to make a snowball...?

Cát searches on her phone. She
goes out and makes a snowball. She
heads to Morgan's doorway.

CÁT (CONT'D)
Morning, Morgan. Don't miss the snow! Ra đây
cho tao biêu không-

Cát barges into Morgan's room. It
is empty. She finds his necklace
abandoned. She picks it up.

CÁT (CONT'D)
Why'd you leave this? You never take it off.
You never let me touch it.

A hermit crab pops out of the
Nautilus pendant, startling Cát.

CÁT (CONT'D)
Ah, a hermit crab?! Well... wherever you came
from, it was probably *somewhere cute*. I can't
believe he'd hide you away from me! As a good
friend of Bagaduce, I won't keep you away from-

Cát holds the horseshoe shell. It
suddenly becomes sentient, causing
her to drop them.

BAGADUCE (V.O.)
Me?

CÁT
Ah!! You- you're not coming from anywhere good!

BAGADUCE (V.O.)
I come from the river. I'd say it's good as
good can be.

CÁT

Okay, spirit of the river... What I heard about spirits is that you're all knowing.

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

Water knows very little. The spirit of the air is everywhere.

CÁT

Do they know where Morgan Tran is?

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

He is in the shell of his former self.

CÁT

Don't you mean HE'S A shell of his former self?

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

This is no riddle. He's a literal hermit.

CÁT

What's new?

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

Put me on your head...

CÁT

That... would be.

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

Trust me.

Cát wears Bagaduce on her head.

A life-sized Morgan could reappear in a horseshoe crab costume or he could remain voice-overed.

MORGAN

Do not trust them!

CÁT

No no no. It's not possible. But then... everything eventually evolves into a crab...

MORGAN

CATHY!

CÁT

Okay, don't get your shells in a twist. How...?

MORGAN

I don't know! I lied in bed, saw snow, then-

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

You saw the moon too right?

MORGAN

Yes, the moon.

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

Just making sure it ain't a mistake.

MORGAN

I wished I could hide forever then poof! Next thing I knew, fingerless. Spineless-

CÁT

No change there.

Morgan pinches Cát.

CÁT (CONT'D)

Ow! The pincers are wicked cool. And you can't be cool. Turn him back, Bagaduce!

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

Change is hard when you are a living fossil.

MORGAN

Could you have at least made me fit in my Nautilus shell. It's so loose...

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

You'll grow into it.

CÁT

But you changed him last night...

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

With the help of the nearly full moon.

CÁT

Another one is tonight. We can wait. I can find a board game your size, Morgan.

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

You must go to Relic Island!

CÁT

Have you heard of this board game, Morgan?

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

It is where you call upon the spirits to take me home.

MORGAN

I think it's a real place...

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

You must reach the island and *spark a light stronger than a hunter's full moon* or you stay a hermit forever.

MORGAN

Forever?!

Cát researches on her phone.

CÁT

That's tonight! I cannot seem to find where...
Where is Relic Island?

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

I don't know. You've got them opposable thumbs.
So get moving.

CÁT

You got ten legs...

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

I'm just a voice in a shell, kid...

MORGAN

And I've got ten too...

CÁT

We've twenty hours.

MORGAN

I can't drive with these.

CÁT

I still got my hands.

MORGAN

Even if you had your license, snow's heavy.

CÁT

Let's wait until it melts.

Morgan sighs.

CÁT (CONT'D)

Mày tuong mày nói chuyện voi ai vậy? I've
survived the roads of Ho Chi Minh City on a
scooter. An avalanche is nothing to me.

MORGAN

Besides a new shell that fits me better, I'm
gonna probably need a new car after all this.

CÁT

Is the shell hurting?

MORGAN

A single wind might.

CÁT

Copy, Hermit Boy.

Cát grabs the car keys from
Morgan's room and puts on his
winter coat.

CÁT (CONT'D)

Where'd you stash your allowance? *Question mark-*

MORGAN

I ain't telling you nothing.

CÁT

The underwear drawer?

MORGAN

Noooooooooooooo!!!!!!

Cát grabs a stash of cash.

CÁT

First stop: the pet store!

Cát safely puts Morgan in her coat
pocket and grabs her backpack.
Bagaduce is still on her head.

They run out into the blizzard.

Fade to black.

SCENE 2

PET STORE

The store has a hard time staying
lit with the snowstorm outside.
There are aisles of pet supplies,
a fish tank section, and animal
grooming counter.

Cát enters, looking like she
survived a tightrope over a canyon.

MORGAN

I'd give you a D on a driver's exam.

CÁT

(to her pocket)

D is passing here. Are you naked?! Que- ques-

MORGAN

Anything will pass for a shell but Nautilus. I
don't know. It's been feeling weird to me.

CÁT

So I see some containers of shells labeled
"small" to "medium" and... "assorted?"

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

What is assorted? Modern retail got some hubris. It needs to be a progression to "large." My boy is growing and the stress only makes him grow faster.

MORGAN

I'm a pocket crab! Of course, I'm stressed!

An EMPLOYEE appears, humming.

EMPLOYEE

Sick hat! What's the occasion?

CÁT

Just a fan of arthropods!

EMPLOYEE

You're in the right spot. Looking for a new arthropod friend? We've got great deals on these critters this snow day.

CÁT

I need shells for my naked friend here.

Cát takes Morgan out the pocket.

The employee's eyes LIGHTS UP.

EMPLOYEE

You're really searching for the vibe, huh? Hermits are all about fashion!

The employee leads Cát to a fitting room display. Cát playfully places Morgan on it.

EMPLOYEE (CONT'D)

Ah honey. Nautilus. That is so Cambrian era. Let's size them up and make them sparkle.

CÁT

Morgan enjoys patterns. Geometric shapes.

The employee grabs several natural and brightly painted shells.

EMPLOYEE

Morgan, lovely lovely name. Shell we?

A life-sized Morgan in a horseshoe crab costume may interact with the employee in a real fitting room.

A fun fast-paced pop song plays in the spirit of a makeover montage.

The employee gets a glittery shell causing Morgan to scuttle away.

Cát finds a plain shell which Morgan tries on but doesn't fit.

The employee passes on a sleek black shell. Morgan tries it. It fits for a moment then he instantly gets too big for it.

EMPLOYEE (CONT'D)
(Sentimentally)

They grow up so fast... Time to make an XL section!

The employee writes an XL section.

This montage culminates in Morgan finding a perfectly shaped shell.

MORGAN

This one feels right. Roomy and safe... from winds and TSUNAMIS.

EMPLOYEE

Seashells! Fashion's all about the perfect fit!

Cát pays for the shells and rushes out the store into the blizzard.

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

Now off to someone who can fashion out a map!

Fade to black.

SCENE 3

MARINE MARITIME ACADEMY

It's a short time later in the afternoon.

The historic hallway has an office labeled "Dr. Heather Baxter, Professor of Maritime History."

Cát and Morgan enter.

CÁT

This has to be her... and perfect we are just in time before office hours is over.

Cát knocks on the door.

DR. BAXTER
Someone who knocks? You're no student of mine.

Cát timidly enters.

CÁT
Good day...

DR. BAXTER
Why are you wearing that?

CÁT
This? I'm just a big fan of horseshoe-

DR. BAXTER
Not that. What's that lanyard say...
(Reading Cát's lanyard)
"Cát-" I'll just call you Cathy. "Splake High
School Exchange Student program."

My nephew went there. Rather boring place he
says. It makes these dusty archives bearable.
It is that what brings you here?

CÁT
We need information on the islands going into
the Bagaduce River.

MORGAN
Relic Island!

DR. BAXTER
Is something squeaking in your pocket? Well,
that answers the "we" you're referring to...

CÁT
We're looking for Relic Island.

DR. BAXTER
I don't know what that is. There's thousands of
unnamed islands off the coast.

CÁT
Do you where one can *spark a light stronger*
than a hunter's full moon.

DR. BAXTER
I teach history not philosophy. Give me more
context.

Morgan sees a poster or figurine
of a lighthouse.

MORGAN
She's a fan of lighthouses...

CÁT

Lighthouses!

DR. BAXTER

Lighthouses have a rich history in the Penobscot Bay. Used by European traders as navigation points.

Dr. Baxter pulls out a map and lays it flat on her desk. She marks where old lighthouses are.

DR. BAXTER (CONT'D)

Many lighthouses are empty now. Automated in the 70s. But they continue on. The locals say strange lights appear during the hunter's moon. Old trading routes used to pass close by. It was considered a liminal space. Between worlds. Dangerous currents. So no one should go here.

MORGAN

"Dangerous currents" sounds like a problem for a guy with no arms.

CÁT

Can you define liminal space? *Question mark?*

DR. BAXTER

Question mark...? Alright, it's a place to cross boundaries, like from life to death.

MORGAN

She said she doesn't teach philosophy...

Dr. Baxter crosses out a region of the Penobscot Bay.

DR. BAXTER

A prime example is this channel here. Sailors called it "Annie C. Maguire's Locker." Only fools dared cross it.

CÁT

Another weird Maine name.

DR. BAXTER

You have an obsession with this perplexing riddle. Remind me?

CÁT & BAGADUCE

One must spark a light stronger than a hunter's full moon.

DR. BAXTER

Not to make a light of it. Who's done that?
I'll check on my astrophysics colleague at
Colby. Now I got to teach.

CÁT

Isn't it a snow day?

DR. BAXTER

I got to teach a theatre workshop. Rain or
shine, drama never dies.

Cát takes a photo of the map.

CÁT

Cam on.

DR. BAXTER

You're Vietnamese?

Cát nods.

DR. BAXTER (CONT'D)

When you enroll in this college, take my spring
course. I have so much to share about the Gulf
of Tonkin.

CÁT

In terms of diplomacy, can you help remove a
parking ticket? I didn't know they still do
that on snow days.

DR. BAXTER

I'm powerless there, Cathy.

Cát and Dr. Baxter go their
separate ways.

Fade to black.

SCENE 4

PENOBSCOT BAY

The snowfall is dwindling.

Cát is rowing the boat. She is
exhausted.

MORGAN

You're better at rowing than driving, I'll give
you that.

CÁT

I was born on an island off Vietnam. Trust me,
I can row.

MORGAN

I still don't trust this boat.

CÁT

They didn't check our IDs.

MORGAN

Exactly.

CÁT

Just took cash. / It's the Vietnamese way.

MORGAN

My allowance.

CÁT

They gave me a discount for wearing Bagaduce.

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

I'm not just the spirit of the river, I'm also the spirit of fortune.

CÁT

No luck finding any island with such lighthouses.

Cát looks at her phone.

CÁT (CONT'D)

We're... approaching "Maguire's Locker."

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

Row, girl! Row!

CÁT

Troi đất oi. I've been rowing for hours!

MORGAN

These currents are not in our favors.

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

That's the full moon and high tides for you!

CÁT

The historian said this was dangerous!

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

To sailors with primitive technology. You have that ungodly thing in your hand!

CÁT

A row?

MORGAN

The phone!

CÁT

If Bagaduce had opposable thumbs, they'd spend all their time taking selfies.

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

What's that supposed to mean?

CÁT

All you care about is yourself! It'd be insane if I can't survive a full semester in America!

MORGAN

I can swim!

CÁT

You're a crab!

MORGAN

Oh yeah... I don't wanna be this way forever!

CÁT

Well, you weren't grateful for where you were. Now, look at you!

MORGAN

You're the one erasing yourself. You can think you can just take off your shoe and be simply a horse girl.

CÁT

Taking off shoes is the Vietnamese way. If Eric and Sybil can love you as a washed-up shell of a boy, they can love you as a literal hermit.

MORGAN

It's borrowed time. Borrowed shell. I've outgrown my home.

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

My boy got them spirit in him!

CÁT

That's your doing!

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

It's Maguire's doing... All hail Annie C. Maguire!

A hailstorm suddenly hits with bright lightning flashes.

MORGAN

This feels...

CÁT

I know...

CÁT & MORGAN

...a tsunami!

A massive wave impacts their
rowboat. The boat capsizes.

Cát struggles to hold control and
falls in the water.

Everything is muffled. The
horseshoe crab floats in the
water.

MORGAN

Cát! I'm sorry...

A horseshoe crab surfaces...

CÁT

My legs... I have ten?!

Cát has transformed into a full-
size horseshoe crab. She struggles
to stay afloat in the water.

MORGAN

How art thou arthropod...?

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

Dr. Baxter told ya this liminal space will have
you two worlds.

CÁT

I didn't think I'd miss having you in my head
rather than attached to my very soul...

MORGAN

To the hermit in the sky, have mercy on us.

BAGADUCE (V.O.)

We are at the mercy of the currents. Annie C.
Maguire has us in her embrace!

Black out.

ACT III

SCENE 1

RELIC ISLAND

Night has fallen. The hunter's full moon shines bright with the waves crashing and wind howling. The old stone lighthouse stands against the night sky.

Cát (now a large horseshoe crab) washes up onto the rocky shore, exhausted. Morgan (still a hermit crab) scuttles ashore nearby.

CÁT & MORGAN

We're alive! But we're still arthropods...

MORGAN

The wind out here... it cuts right through you. My new shell is snug, but it doesn't stop the cold.

CÁT

We're armored for a reason. The world has sharp teeth.

Cát notices the lighthouse.

CÁT (CONT'D)

This is it. The light must be inside. We can't hide in the dark forever. Move, Hermit Boy!

Cát and Morgan squeeze through a narrow maintenance entrance or window at the base of the tower.

They navigate the spiral stairs as best they can in their current forms.

MORGAN

This is harder than I thought. My little legs are aching.

CÁT

We're almost there. Hold onto your soul.

They reach the top lantern room. The Fresnel lens is massive, dusty, and automated, but dark.

CÁT (CONT'D)

It's a modern beacon. The power is off. How do we spark a light stronger than a hunter's full moon?

MORGAN

I don't know. There's no switch for "stronger than the moon."

Cát pushes against the automation equipment, knocking a rusted lever. A faint power light flickers, but the bulb remains dark.

CÁT

It's hopeless. We're stuck like this.

A sudden blue glow appears in the center of the room. A group of ethereal horseshoe crab spirits shimmer into existence. They look ancient and judgmental.

CÁT (CONT'D)

The spirits!

MORGAN

They're here! Tell them we saved you!

SPIRIT (V.O.)

You carry the scent of the outcast. The river spirit is not welcome here. This is a place of sanctuary, not restless wandering.

CÁT

We need to light the beacon! Please!

SPIRIT

The light is a test of belonging, Horseshoe Girl. You abandoned your source. They abandoned their grief.

The spirits begin to fade, taking their blue light with them.

MORGAN

Wait!

CÁT

They're leaving us here! We failed. They're right. I've been trying so hard to be someone else, I don't belong anywhere now.

Cát scuttles dejectedly away from the light.

Morgan watches the blue glow
diminish. He looks at his new,
perfect Nautilus shell.

MORGAN

No, we didn't. I've been running from my
memories, but this shell... it fits. It feels
safe.

Morgan holds his shell close. The
blue light pulses around him,
forming a sphere of peace. A soft,
warm melody begins to play.

SCENE 2

MORGAN'S INNER THOUGHTS

The room dissolves into an astral
plane of swirling water and
starlight.

His Indonesian MOTHER and FATHER
appear, smiling warmly. They wear
traditional clothing.

MOTHER

(in Indonesian)

You carried us with you, Morgan. In that shell.
You remembered the source.

FATHER

(in Indonesian)

This is your armor now, the love you found in
the world.

Morgan (as a hermit crab) scuttles
towards them.

MORGAN

My shell... it fits now.

MOTHER

(in Indonesian)

You are a bigger man now, my son. You are home.

They embrace. The light swells.

SCENE 3

RELIC ISLAND

The astral plane snaps back to
reality. The room is blindingly
bright.

The entire Fresnel lens is illuminated, the bulb somehow sparking to life, blazing with a light stronger than the full moon.

The light pulses. In the center of the room, Cát and Morgan stand human again, blinking in the glare. Morgan still clutches his Nautilus necklace. Cát is in her horse hoodie and jeans.

MORGAN

It wasn't about a bigger light, Cát. It was about a bigger heart. The shelter of home.

CÁT

We may humans again, but you have the philosophy of a hermit.

MORGAN

I can feel my allowance in my pocket again!

CÁT

So roi đó phải không?

MORGAN

Yeah. It's over. Let's go to-

They hear a boats approaching. A searchlight sweeps across the windows.

CÁT

The light!

MORGAN (CONT'D)

The Coast Guard...

CÁT (CONT'D)

It finally feels like home.

Morgan embraces Cát. He smells like salmon and high tides. Cát is home.

CÁT (CONT'D)

The Vietnamese way is to take off your shoes. I'm keeping mine on.

MORGAN

That's the Maine way.

Black out.

END OF PLAY